

RICHARD KWAKU OPOKU

Cybersecurity | Cloud Security | Network Security | MSc Applicant

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ACADEMIC PROFILE

Year 3 Computer Science & Engineering student (UMaT, First Class standing - 80.87 CWA) applying to MSc programmes in cybersecurity, cloud security, and network security. Combines formal security training (One Million Coders member, Google Cybersecurity on Coursera, ISC2 CC in progress) with coursework in information security and cryptography, hands-on AWS security labs, and production systems where access control and secure deployment are first-class concerns.

Research interests: cloud security architecture, identity & access management, network defence and monitoring, applied cryptography, secure DevOps / cloud-native hardening, and risk management (NIST CSF).

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Engineering

Year 3 - Expected 2027

University of Mines and Technology (UMaT), Tarkwa, Ghana

- CWA: 80.87 (First Class standing)
- Relevant coursework: Cloud Computing, Software Engineering, Database Systems, AI/ML Systems, IoT & Embedded Systems, Information Security
- Security-aligned study: Cryptography, TCP/IP networking, Linux administration, SQL for security analytics, risk assessment, incident response, CIA triad, NIST CSF

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Cryptography Research & Implementation

Information Security course, UMaT

- Research-led coursework on symmetric and asymmetric encryption with practical implementation (course-based academic project)

TEACHING & LEADERSHIP

Teaching Assistant - C# Programming

Dept. of Computer Science & Engineering, UMaT

- Supported lecture delivery, lab sessions, and student coursework under faculty supervision

Tutor

AAENICS Robotics Club, UMaT

- Mentored members on robotics, embedded systems, and hands-on hardware projects

Hardware Hackathon Organizer

AAENICS / UMaT

- Organized and facilitated hardware-focused hackathons for student teams

CERTIFICATIONS & SECURITY TRAINING

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (CCP)

Amazon Web Services (Credly)

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate

Foundations, Risk, Networks, Linux & SQL (4 of 8 courses completed)

One Million Coders Member - Cybersecurity (Coursera)

One Million Coders

ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)

In progress

Machine Learning Specialization

Stanford University & DeepLearning.AI (Coursera)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cybersecurity & networking: Linux, Bash, SQL; Wireshark, tcpdump; TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, HTTP/S; firewalls, VPNs, network hardening; cryptography; CIA triad, NIST CSF, risk assessment, incident response planning

Cloud security: AWS (IAM, S3 policy hardening, Lambda execution roles, API Gateway, Amplify, EC2, VPC); least-privilege access; block public access; CI/CD pipeline security

Software (supporting): C#, Python, Node.js, TypeScript, React/Next.js, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Docker, Git

SECURITY & CLOUD EXPERIENCE

Cloud Practitioner Intern - AWS re/Start

Jan 2026 - Apr 2026

AmaliTech (Online)

- Cloud architecture, IAM, VPC, EC2, S3, Linux, Python, networking, and databases

Hackathon Participant

Jan 2026 - Apr 2026

AmaliTech (AWS re/Start)

- Collaborated in a team to build a SaaS for automating hospital queues using AWS Lambda, API Gateway, Cognito, DynamoDB, Amplify, and related services

One Million Coders Member - Cybersecurity

Coursera / One Million Coders

- Studying cybersecurity on Coursera, including Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate pathway (4 of 8 courses completed)

AWS Hands-On Security Labs

Personal AWS account (us-west-1) - documented on LinkedIn

- Lab 1 - Secure CI/CD: Amplify Hosting + GitHub; HTTPS portfolio deploy
- Lab 2 - Storage security: S3 block public access; least-privilege IAM scoped to private/ prefix
- Lab 3 - Serverless API: Lambda + API Gateway with dedicated IAM execution role

SECURITY-RELEVANT PROJECTS

Quads - Campus marketplace

quadsmarket.tech

- RBAC (buyer/seller/admin), Paystack escrow, API on AWS EC2 behind Cloudflare, MongoDB Atlas

Scholar - AI scholarship platform

schorla.vercel.app

- Document ingestion for CVs, transcripts, SOPs; Supabase auth and access control for sensitive data

UMaTBOT (MINEBOT) - Campus helpdesk

Telegram Bot, Python

- Automated FAQ and resource delivery with controlled bot access patterns

InsightFlow, StudyMate, Sheet2SaaS

Shipped SaaS products

- Auth, database security, and production deployment (Vercel/Supabase/PostgreSQL)

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

IoT Hackathon Developer

Robotics Club (AAENICS), UMaT - 2026

- ESP32 + MQTT embedded prototypes; team-based automation challenge with panel evaluation

Hackathon Participant

Dept. of Computer Science & Engineering, UMaT - 2025

- Collaborative software solution design and presentation